

RAND HALASA

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ABOUT

Software Engineering graduate from the University of Sydney with experience building AI-driven and interactive digital systems. Skilled in SEO/ GEO audits, computer vision, real-time data processing, and full-stack development. Interested in applying technology to enhance public engagement and educational experiences, particularly through building accessible digital platforms.

EDUCATION

Aug 2022 - Jun 2026	University of Sydney Bachelor of Engineering (Honours), Software Engineering Honours title: Evaluating Fairness in AI-Powered Medical Chatbots.
Sep 2022 - Nov 2022	University of Franche-Comté French as a foreign language and French linguistics

WORK EXPERIENCE

April 2026 – Present	SEO Specialist, Search it Local - Automated key SEO reporting, monitoring, and optimization workflows, increasing team productivity by 13x and significantly reducing manual effort. - Rank clients on the first page of google by performing onsite and off page SEO. - Review client rankings and provide evidence of when they were reached via video and email updates. Improve their speed.
Feb 2023 – Present	Programming Tutor, Independent - Delivered 1-on-1 tutoring in Java and Python to university students; average student score improved by ~20%. - Created tailored problem sets, debugged code, and coached students in algorithms, testing, and clean code.
Aug 2024 – Nov 2024	Software Engineering Intern, WinBoard - Built a computer-vision pipeline to analyse ad engagement in real time and from recordings. - Extracted dwell time, sentiment, and demographic signals using YOLOv8 and FairFace; implemented GDPR-compliant anonymisation. - Delivered interactive dashboards and configured scalable cloud deployment for concurrent video processing.
May 2024 – Nov 2024	Marketing Director, Sydney University Women in Engineering Responsible for designing promotional material, promoting events, and managing SUWIE social media platforms.
Nov 2023 – Feb 2024	AI Development Intern, MobiSoft Mobility - Built AI tooling to enhance customs tracking workflows for Middle Eastern government clients. - Integrated semantic search using Apache Solr and Vectara for multilingual item description retrieval.

PROJECTS

Below are some of my favorite projects. For more, visit my website and GitHub.

May 2024 – Jun 2024

P2P File Transfer System, C

- Designed and optimised a robotic control system, realizing a 12% performance improvement, in C Programming language.
- Coordinated testing and validation, ensuring compliance with industry standards.

Feb 2024 – Apr 2024

Space Invaders, Java

- Rebuilt the classic arcade game using OOP and design patterns.
- Added JSON-based game customization and enhanced UX with score/lives/timer.

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING

Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

Marketing Director, Collateral Repair Project (Volunteer)

- Designed brand-consistent promotional assets (social, email, print) for events, aligning creativity with audience insights.
- Planned and executed targeted, data-driven campaigns (segmentation, A/B testing) that increased student engagement and event turnout.

Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

English Tutor, Paper Airplanes (Volunteer)

- Led weekly English tutoring sessions and community service initiatives, fostering language proficiency and leadership.

Jul 2024 – Nov 2024

ENGO Peer Mentor, University of Sydney

- Provided mentorship and guidance to a group of engineering students, helping them navigate their first year.

OTHER

Languages

English (Native), Arabic (Native), French (Intermediate), Mandarin (Beginner).

Skills

Programming: Python, Java, JavaScript, C, RStudio, MySQL, PostgreSQL, HTML, CSS, Vue.js, React.js.
Data/ML: TensorFlow, OpenCV, YOLOv8, FairFace; classical CV pipelines; model evaluation and deployment.
Search: Apache Solr, Elasticsearch, Vectara (semantic search).
Web/Cloud: REST APIs, dashboards, scalable deployment, real-time processing, AWS Cloud, MongoDB.
Tools: Git, Linux, Docker, Agile teamwork, documentation, AI.

Certification

Introducing Generative AI with AWS, Udacity and AWS Academy